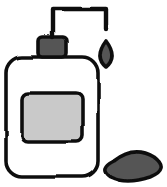
UNIT 3 · DRAW + PAINT 1 · KNOW YOUR TOOL

TEMPERA

(INTRO WORKSHEET)



Tempera is the classic poster paint: thick, bright and flat. It mixes with water, dries in minutes and covers what's underneath, so you can paint light over dark. It's the best paint for learning to **mix color**, because what you mix is what you get.

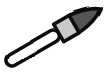
01 THE TEMPERA KIT



Tempera paint
One pump is plenty. Take a little, come back for more.



Flat brush
Square tip. Fills big areas and makes crisp edges.



Round brush
Pointed tip. Lines, curves and small details.



Palette
Where you mix. Keep white and black in their own corners.



Water cup
For rinsing only. Change it when it turns to mud.



Paper towel
Blot the brush after rinsing, so water doesn't thin your paint.

02 HOW TEMPERA BEHAVES



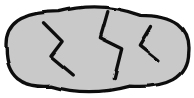
It's opaque
Once dry, a new layer hides the one under it.



Water thins it
Too much water = streaky and see-through.

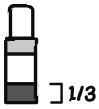


It dries fast + flat
Minutes, not hours. Colors dry a little lighter.

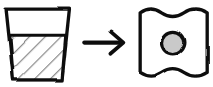


Thick paint cracks
Two thin coats beat one gloopy one.

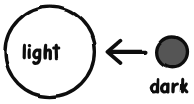
03 HANDLING PAINT



Load 1/3 of the brush
Dip the tip, wipe the extra on the rim.



Rinse, then blot
Every time you change colors.



Dark into light
Add the dark color a dab at a time.



Don't park the brush
Left in water, the bristles bend for good.

GOLDEN RULE: A little dark goes a long way. Start with the **light** color and add the **dark** one a dab at a time. You can always add more. You can't take it back out.

04 COLOR WORDS



← **TINTS (color + white)** **HUE** **SHADES (color + black)** →

Hue: the pure color, straight from the bottle.

Tint: a hue with white added. Lighter.

Tone: a hue with gray added. Duller.

Value scale: even steps from light to dark.

Value: how light or dark a color is.

Shade: a hue with black added. Darker.

Opaque: you can't see through it.

Matte: a flat finish with no shine.

UNIT 3 · TIER 1 · SKILL BUILDER · 2 POINTS

TEMPERA WARM-UPS

Complete all five boxes with tempera. This isn't about making something pretty. It's about finding out what the paint does. **Do box 2A first**, so it's dry by the end.

1 BRUSH MARKS

One color, three marks. Find out how many kinds of line one brush can make.

A · flat brush, wide stroke	B · flat brush on its edge	C · round brush: a line, then dots

2 COVER-UP TEST **start now, finish last**

A: fill the box with a **dark** color and let it dry. B: at the very end, paint a **light** color over the right half of A.

A · dark first	B · light on top (when dry)

Did the light color hide the dark one? Yes / Kind of / No

3 WATER TEST

A · paint straight from the palette	B · the same paint + lots of water

Which one hides the paper? _____ Which one is streaky? _____

4 VALUE SCALE: TINTS TO SHADES

Pick **one** color and paint it pure in the middle box. Going **left**, add a little more **white** to each box. Going **right**, add a little more **black**. Aim for even jumps, like stairs.

← TINTS				HUE		SHADES →		
almost white			a little white	**pure color**	a little black			almost black

MIXING TIP: For tints, start with **white** and add color. For shades, start with **color** and add a tiny dab of black.

5 SMOOTH BLEND

Same color. Blend from white, to pure color, to black with **no steps showing**. Work fast, while the paint is wet.

white	black

QUICK FACT: Tempera is one of the oldest paints there is. For centuries, painters mixed their color with egg yolk to make it stick. The school kind swaps the egg for a binder that washes out with water.